

# C. Luke Watson

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## Research Interests

Public Economics, Urban Economics, Industrial Organization  
Tax Incidence, Bank Branching and Competition, Housing Demand

## Employment

|                                                                 |                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Senior Financial Economist, Center for Financial Research, FDIC | Aug 2023            |
| Financial Economist, Center for Financial Research, FDIC        | Aug 2021 - Aug 2023 |

## Education

|                                            |             |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Ph.D. Economics, Michigan State University | 2015 - 2021 |
| M.A. Economics, Old Dominion University    | 2013 - 2015 |
| B.A. Economics, Old Dominion University    | 2009 - 2013 |

## Publications

|                                                                  |      |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| “A Test for Pricing Power in Urban Housing Markets” (with O.Ziv) | 2025 |
| – Accepted, Review of Economics and Statistics                   |      |

## Working Papers

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|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| “Is the Rent Too High: Land Ownership and Monopoly Power” (with O.Ziv) | 2025 |
| – R&R, Real Estate Economics                                           |      |

## Selected Works in Progress

“Bank Competition for Neighborhood Deposits” (with M.Kutzbach, G.Wagner)  
“Estimating Markups using Pass-Through Regressions” (with O.Ziv)  
“A Test for Market Definition in Aggregate Logit Models with an Application to Retail Banking”  
“CBDC News and Market Sentiment” (with S.Borkhoche, J.Yung)  
– Currently paused due to EO 14178

## Prior Employment

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|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Instructor : Development Economics (Michigan State University)                         | Fall 2020   |
| Instructor : Principles of Microeconomics (Old Dominion University)                    | Summer 2015 |
| TA : (MSU) Public Revenues, Ec. of Poverty & Income, Int’l Trade (x4), Urban Econ (x3) |             |
| Interm.Micro, Intro.Micro, Intro.Macro                                                 | 2015-2020   |
| TA : (AEASP) Foundations Microeconomics and Mathematics                                | Summer 2017 |
| RA : (MSU) Oren Ziv, Prabhat Barnwal, (ODU) Gary Wagner, Tim Komarek                   | 2013-2020   |
| Barista : Starbucks                                                                    | 2009-2015   |

## Presentations

2025: Richmond Fed, AREUEA Nat'l, NYC DOF, DC Urban Day.  
 2024: Lincoln Institute UE & PE Conference. 2023: Mid-Atlantic Trade Workshop, NTA.  
 2022: AREUEA / ASSA, AREUEA Nat'l, NTA, UEA (USA). 2021: UEA (Europe).  
 2020: Ohio University, MVEA, NTA. 2019: NTA.

## FDIC Projects

|                                                                            |           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Memo: DI Limits Increases [Internal]                                       | 2025      |
| Deposit Study: GFC Runs [Internal, In-progress]                            | 2025      |
| Deposit Study: Deposit Stability [Internal, In-progress]                   | 2025      |
| Options for Deposit Insurance Reform [Public]                              | 2023      |
| Literature Review on Digital Currencies and Financial Stability [Internal] | 2022      |
| Crypto-Watch Paper Round-Up [Internal]                                     | 2022-2025 |

## Dissertation Work on EITC

|                                                                                      |      |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| "The General Equilibrium Incidence of the Earned Income Tax Credit"                  | 2021 |
| "Estimating Supply & Demand Elasticities Using a Single Tax Rate with GE Spillovers" | 2021 |
| "The Local Labor Market Effects of State EITC Supplements"                           | 2021 |

## Service

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| AEASP-FDIC - Experiential Learning Partner                               | Summer 2024 |
| FDIC - History of the FDIC presenter                                     | 2024-2025   |
| FDIC - CFR Seminar Coordinator                                           | 2022-2024   |
| FDIC - Reader for FDIC Consumer Research Symposium                       | 2022-2023   |
| Michigan State University - Applied Economics Student Workshop Organizer | 2017-2020   |
| Michigan State University - Graduate Student Seminar Organizer           | 2018-2020   |
| Michigan State University - Graduate Instruction Committee               | 2017-2018   |
| Old Dominion University - Ad Hoc Committee on Birthday Singing           | 2013-2015   |

## Referee Service

Contemporary Economic Policy, International Tax and Public Finance, Journal of Financial Services Research, Journal of Real Estate Finance and Economics, Journal of Urban Economics, Public Finance Review

## Awards and Grants

|                                                            |           |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Mission Achievement Award (FDIC)                           | 2025      |
| Star Award (FDIC)                                          | 2024      |
| Mission Achievement Award (FDIC)                           | 2023      |
| Dissertation Completion Fellowship (MSU)                   | 2020      |
| Outstanding Graduate Economics Student Award (ODU)         | 2015      |
| Graduate Student Tuition Fellowship (ODU)                  | 2013-2015 |
| Constant Dominion Business Student Merit Scholarship (ODU) | 2013      |
| Town-N-Gown Scholarship (ODU)                              | 2013      |
| Governor's Technology Tuition Scholarship (ODU)            | 2009-2013 |
| Time Magazine Person of the Year (shared)                  | 2006      |

## Memberships

American Economics Association, American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association, National Tax Association